

ZipDash Quick Commerce
Internal Operations Policy Manual
Version 3.2 | Effective: 01 January 2026
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1.1 Purpose

This Code of Conduct sets out the standards of behaviour expected of all ZipDash dark store employees, including pickers, packers, dispatch staff, store managers, and support personnel. Adherence to this code is a condition of employment at ZipDash.

1.2 Professional Conduct

All employees must:

- Treat colleagues, delivery riders, and visitors with respect at all times
- Maintain a clean and organised workstation throughout their shift
- Report to duty in the prescribed uniform with ID badge visible
- Refrain from use of personal mobile phones in active picking and packing zones
- Not share login credentials for any ZipDash system with another employee

1.3 Confidentiality

Employees must not disclose operational data, store throughput figures, customer information, or internal process details to any external party. Breach of confidentiality is grounds for immediate termination.

1.4 Workplace Safety

All employees must:

- Wear non-slip footwear at all times on the store floor
- Not run or use personal vehicles inside the store premises
- Report any spill, breakage, or hazard to the shift supervisor immediately
- Use designated lifting techniques for items above 10 kg
- Ensure all racking is fully secured before loading stock

1.5 Anti-Harassment Policy

ZipDash maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment of any kind, including verbal, physical, or digital harassment. Any complaint must be raised with the People team within 48 hours of the incident.

Investigations will be completed within 10 working days.

Retaliation against complainants is strictly prohibited.

1.6 Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose to their store manager any personal relationship with a vendor, supplier, or competitor of ZipDash. Undisclosed conflicts of interest are grounds for disciplinary action.

1.7 Social Media Policy

Employees may not post images, videos, or descriptions of ZipDash internal operations, store layouts, or fulfillment processes on any social media platform without prior written approval from the Communications team. This includes dark store floor plans, inventory counts, throughput dashboards, and customer order data.

1.8 Gifts and Gratuities

Employees must not accept gifts, cash, or favours from vendors, riders, or customers with a value exceeding ₹500. Any gift above this threshold must be declared to the store manager within 24 hours.

1.9 Disciplinary Process

The following escalation process applies to all code violations:

Step 1: Verbal warning from shift supervisor (documented)

Step 2: Written warning issued by store manager

Step 3: Final written warning with performance improvement plan

Step 4: Termination with 30 days notice (or immediate for gross misconduct)

Gross misconduct includes theft, violence, wilful damage to property, data breach, and falsification of operational records.

1.10 Grievance Procedure

Any employee wishing to raise a formal grievance must submit a written complaint to the People team using the ZipDash internal portal (people.zipdash.in). Complaints are acknowledged within 2 working days and resolved within 15 working days.

1.11 Amendments to Code of Conduct

ZipDash reserves the right to amend this Code of Conduct at any time. Employees will be notified of any amendments via the store notice board and internal app notification. Continued employment constitutes acceptance of any updated terms.

1.12 Acknowledgement

All employees must sign the Code of Conduct Acknowledgement Form on their first day of employment. A copy is retained in the employee's personnel file. Failure to sign does not exempt an employee from the obligations set out in this document.

2.1 Shift Structure

ZipDash HSR Layout dark store operates on a three-shift model:

- Shift 1: 06:00 AM – 02:00 PM (8 hours)
- Shift 2: 02:00 PM – 10:00 PM (8 hours)
- Shift 3: 10:00 PM – 06:00 AM (8 hours)

All shifts are fully staffed seven days a week, including public holidays.

Shift handover time: 15 minutes overlap between outgoing and incoming shift.

2.2 Attendance Marking

Attendance is recorded via biometric fingerprint scanner at the store entrance.

Employees must mark IN and OUT for each shift. Manual attendance is not permitted except in cases of documented biometric equipment failure, which must be approved by the store manager.

2.3 Late Arrival Policy

An employee arriving more than 10 minutes after shift start is marked late.

Three late arrivals in a calendar month result in a written warning.

Six late arrivals in a calendar month result in one day's unpaid leave.

2.4 Absenteeism Policy

Unplanned absences must be communicated to the shift supervisor at least 2 hours before shift start via the ZipDash staff app.

Planned leave must be applied for a minimum of 5 working days in advance using the leave management module.

Consecutive unplanned absences beyond 3 days without notification will be treated as job abandonment.

2.5 Leave Entitlements

- Earned Leave: 15 days per calendar year (accrual: 1.25 days/month)
- Sick Leave: 12 days per calendar year
- Casual Leave: 6 days per calendar year
- Maternity Leave: 26 weeks (as per Maternity Benefit Act, 1961)
- Paternity Leave: 5 working days
- National/Festival Holidays: As per state government notification

Leave encashment is permitted for Earned Leave only, subject to a maximum of 30 days accumulated balance at year end.

2.6 Overtime Policy

Overtime is defined as any hours worked beyond 8 hours in a single shift or beyond 48 hours in a single week.

Overtime rate: 1.5x base hourly wage

Overtime must be pre-approved by the store manager. Unapproved overtime will not be compensated at the overtime rate.

Maximum overtime permitted per employee: 10 hours per week.

2.7 Shift Swap Policy

Employees may request a shift swap with a colleague of equivalent role and training level. Both parties must submit a shift swap form to the store manager 24 hours in advance. Swaps not approved in advance will not be recognised for payroll or attendance purposes.

2.8 Night Shift Allowance

Employees working Shift 3 (10 PM – 6 AM) are entitled to a night shift allowance of ₹75 per shift, paid as part of the monthly salary.

2.9 Holiday Pay

Employees required to work on declared public holidays are entitled to double pay for hours worked, or one compensatory off day, at the employee's discretion, subject to store manager approval.

2.10 Payroll Processing

Salaries are processed on the last working day of each calendar month. Salary slips are issued digitally through the ZipDash employee app. Any payroll discrepancy must be raised with the People team within 7 working days of salary credit.

3.1 FSSAI Compliance

ZipDash is licensed under the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) for all dark stores handling food items. All store managers must ensure the following:

- FSSAI license displayed prominently at the store entrance
- Quarterly FSSAI self-inspection completed and filed
- Annual renewal of FSSAI license submitted 60 days before expiry
- All food handlers possess valid Food Safety Training certificates

3.2 Temperature Monitoring

All cold storage zones must maintain temperatures as follows:

- Fresh produce (fruits & vegetables): 2°C – 8°C
- Dairy products: 1°C – 4°C
- Frozen goods: -18°C or below
- Ambient FMCG: 15°C – 25°C

Temperature logs must be recorded every 4 hours using the digital sensor dashboard and reviewed daily by the store manager.

4.1 Rider Eligibility

To be onboarded as a ZipDash delivery rider, candidates must:

- Hold a valid two-wheeler driving licence (minimum 1 year old)
- Own or have access to a motorcycle or scooter in roadworthy condition
- Possess a valid Aadhaar card and PAN card for KYC verification
- Have a clean police verification record (no pending criminal cases)
- Possess a smartphone compatible with the ZipDash Rider app (Android 10+)

4.2 Onboarding Process

Step 1: Online application via the ZipDash Rider portal (rider.zipdash.in)

Step 2: Document verification (licence, Aadhaar, PAN, vehicle RC)

Step 3: 3-day induction programme (store orientation, app training, route familiarisation)

Step 4: Supervised delivery trial (minimum 10 deliveries with mentor rider)

Step 5: Independent activation on the ZipDash rider app

Throughput and BottleNeck Definition

5.1 Introduction

This section defines the official operational metrics, measurement methodologies, and performance standards used across all ZipDash dark stores. These definitions are authoritative and must be used consistently in all operational reporting, audits, and capex justification documents.

5.2 Orders Per Hour (OPH)

Orders Per Hour (OPH) is the primary throughput metric for all ZipDash dark store operations. OPH is defined as the number of customer orders fully processed by a given fulfillment stage within a 60-minute window.

Measurement rules:

- OPH is measured at each stage independently: picking, packing, and dispatch
- An order is counted as processed at a stage when it exits that stage and enters the next (or, for dispatch, when it is handed to the rider)
- Partial orders (incomplete picks, rejected packs) are not counted until fully resolved

5.3 Peak Hour vs. Off-Peak Definitions

Peak hours at ZipDash are defined as:

- Morning peak: 08:00 AM – 10:00 AM
- Evening peak: 07:00 PM – 09:00 PM

All throughput benchmarking for capex and staffing decisions must be based on peak hour OPH, not daily average OPH, unless explicitly stated otherwise in the relevant analysis brief.

Off-peak OPH is used only for staffing optimisation decisions (minimum crew sizing, shift taper planning).

5.4 Capacity Utilisation

Capacity Utilisation for a given stage is defined as:

$$\text{Actual OPH} \div \text{Installed Capacity OPH} \times 100\%$$

A stage operating above 90% capacity utilisation is considered at risk of becoming a bottleneck and must be flagged in the weekly ops review.

A stage operating above 100% capacity utilisation is classified as an active bottleneck and requires immediate intervention.

5.5 OEE (Overall Equipment Effectiveness)

For stages using automated equipment (conveyor systems, scanning arrays), OEE is tracked as:

$$\text{OEE} = \text{Availability} \times \text{Performance} \times \text{Quality Rate}$$

- Availability: % of scheduled time the equipment was operational
- Performance: $\text{Actual OPH} \div \text{Ideal OPH during operational time}$
- Quality Rate: Orders processed without rework or reprocessing

OEE benchmarks for ZipDash dark store equipment:

- World class: $\geq 85\%$
- Acceptable: 70–84%
- Requires intervention: $< 70\%$

OEE data is captured automatically via the ZipDash Operations Intelligence Platform (ZIP) and accessible to store managers via the manager dashboard.

5.6 Shift-Level vs. Day-Level Reporting

All throughput data must be recorded and reported at the shift level (not aggregated to day level) to enable identification of shift-specific performance patterns. Day-level summaries are permissible only as secondary reporting layers.

5.7 Data Quality Standards for Operational Logs

All throughput logs submitted for analysis, benchmarking, or capex justification must meet the following data quality standards:

- Completeness: All shifts for all days in the reporting period must be captured. Missing shift data must be flagged and the reason documented.
- Accuracy: OPH figures must be system-generated from the ZipDash OPS platform. Manual entries are permitted only for periods of system downtime and must be clearly labelled as manual estimates.
- Timeliness: Shift data must be uploaded to the central log within 2 hours of shift end.
- Flagging: Any shift or day affected by equipment failure, staffing events, or external disruptions must be flagged in the log with a reason code and description.

Data quality failures in submitted logs will result in rejection of any capex or staffing proposals that rely on those logs.

5.8 Steady-State Throughput Definition

Steady-State Throughput:

The steady-state throughput rate for any fulfillment stage is defined as the average Orders Per Hour (OPH), computed across a minimum of two (2) consecutive clean operational weeks.

A clean operational week is defined as any 7-day period in which:

- (a) No system outages, equipment failures, or technology disruptions were recorded that artificially suppressed or inflated OPH for any stage or shift, AND
- (b) No staffing events (mass absenteeism, induction periods, large-scale redeployments) that materially affected throughput were recorded, AND
- (c) The week has not been formally flagged by the store's Ops Team as non-representative in the operational log.

Any week that fails conditions (a), (b), or (c) above must be excluded from the steady-state baseline computation. Including flagged weeks in a steady-state calculation will result in rejection of any proposal relying on that figure.

5.9 Binding Constraint (Bottleneck) Stage Definition

The binding constraint is defined as the fulfillment stage — among picking, packing, and dispatch — with the lowest steady-state throughput rate, computed per Section 5.8 above.

The binding constraint stage is the primary limiting factor for overall dark store OPH and must be the sole target of any capacity expansion capex proposal. Proposals that direct capex toward a non-bottleneck stage will be rejected at the ops review stage.

Design Target:

The approved design throughput target for the HSR Layout dark store is 55 orders/hour, as ratified in the FY26 Ops Plan by the COO

5.10 Throughput Gap and Capex Sufficiency

A capex proposal for stage expansion is considered sufficient if the post-expansion capacity of the bottleneck stage equals or exceeds the design target OPH.

If post-expansion capacity falls short of the design target, the capex is classified as partially sufficient. The proposal must include a supplementary action plan identifying the remaining gap and the operational (non-capex) measures required to close it.

Capex proposals that do not include a throughput gap analysis referenced to the steady-state baseline (Section 5.8) and the design target will be returned for revision before review.

